

match in first-person view and really get the arm of your opponent jumping out of the screen and right at your face! Simply brilliant!

And a lot of graphics manufacturers and researchers are already working on making this happen, as 3D is seen as the future of video game software.

In December 2008, the CTO of Blitz Games announced that they would bring stereoscopic 3D gaming and movie viewing to the Xbox 360 and Playstation 3 with their own technology. Stereoscopic 3D games were first demonstrated publicly on the PS3 in January 2009 at the Consumer Electronics Show. Journalists were shown *Wipeout HD* and *Gran Turismo 5 Prologue* in 3D as a demonstration of how the technology might work if it is implemented in the future.

Nvidia, on the other hand, has already been working overtime to get 3D gaming out and about. The company has already come out with its Nvidia 3D Vision kit, that relies on a pair of custom glasses (and no, they don't look like the ridiculous red-and-blue ones), an underlying software and compatible Nvidia hardware.

The company has previously stated that it is in talks with video game developers and console manufacturers about integrating the technology in the next generation of devices.

Last year, Oscar-winning director James Cameron was quoted as saying that Ubisoft had already developed a stereoscopic 3D game for the Xbox 360 and got it working. The title in question was the game based on Cameron's upcoming 3D film, *Avatar*.

While it is not known whether the next generation of games will be using stereoscopic 3D as a mainstay of all its games or not, one thing is for sure – this is one technology that is bound to hit gamers in the near future.

4.3 Brain-computer interfaces

Motion-sensitive gaming is great and definitely a very real part of the future of video games. The world of gaming is unlikely to be going into the field of touch-sensitive screens, as the technology has pretty much skipped that for the next generation of user interface with Project Natal – gestures.

Similarly, most technology pundits are predicting that voice-based interfaces will be the next thing in how you use your computer. While the idea might suit simply daily operations, it simply is not rich enough to encompass the complex mechanisms of playing a video game.

Honestly, can you imagine shouting “Shoot!” to start firing and “Halt!” to stop, with intermediary bursts of “Duck!”, “Take cover!” and “Retreat!”? Apart from an absolutely absurd and loud way of playing a game, it would also completely ruin the concept of multiplayer chatting.

So it makes sense that if computers decide to go with speech recognition technologies for their interface, video games will again be skipping this one and moving on to a much cooler alternative: controlling your character by just using your thoughts!

Scientists have long been working on brain-computer interfaces, with success stories